

ANALYTICAL POLITICS II: INTRODUCTION

ANALYTICAL POLITICS

Public policy involves making decisions on behalf of a group

As such, it is inherently political:

- ▶ Group members differ in what they want
- ▶ Policy decisions cannot be separated from power, values, interests, and conflict within group

The AP sequence is about the politics of policy making

AP I FOCUSED ON GROUPS

In AP I you learned how groups

- ▶ Set collective goals
- ▶ Take collective action when they agree on the goals
- ▶ Make collective decisions when they disagree on goals

In AP II we focus on how **leaders** help achieve groups' goals

AP II WILL FOCUS ON LEADERS

- ▶ Presidents, prime ministers, mayors
- ▶ CEO's
- ▶ Managers, heads of division
- ▶ Deans, department chairs
- ▶ Heads of Student Government

We address four main questions about leaders:

- ▶ Why do groups have leaders?
- ▶ How do we make leaders act in group's interest?
- ▶ How can leaders exercise power and implement policy?
- ▶ What pitfalls should leaders avoid to be successful?

WHY DO YOU NEED TO KNOW THIS?

As a potential leader:

- ▶ How do you achieve your goals?

As a group member:

- ▶ How to structure institutions to make sure your leader acts in your interest?
- ▶ How do you shape your proposals to gain the leader's support?

ORGANIZATION OF THE COURSE

Weekly lectures

Weekly Problem Sets

- ▶ Available on Canvass
- ▶ Due by Thursday at 3:30
- ▶ Graded on completion
- ▶ You will receive immediate feedback

Weekly Discussion Sessions

- ▶ Thursday evening and Fridays
- ▶ Held by PhD TAs: Alex and Hongding
- ▶ Not compulsory but recommended
- ▶ Will cover Problem Set questions

ORGANIZATION OF THE COURSE

Office hours

- ▶ I have weekly office hours
- ▶ MPP TA's hold many hours of drop-in and sign-up office hours

Canvas discussion:

- ▶ Post any questions about the course there
- ▶ Do **not** email questions about the content of the course
- ▶ For logistical issues, email core-ap@uchicago.edu

Three graded assessments:

- ▶ Week 2 and 6 during Friday Assessment Period
- ▶ Final in Week 10

A FEW PRACTICAL NOTES

Read the syllabus

Check Canvas

Come to class (mandatory) and do readings

Do not use electronics